

COURSE SYLLABUS

AI Fundamentals for Knowledge Workers

COURSE NUMBER

AFK-001

DURATION

1 day · 4 modules (+ Course Orientation)

AUDIENCE LEVEL

Beginner

FORMAT

Instructor-Led / Self-Paced

Course syllabus

COURSE OVERVIEW

This course teaches foundational generative AI principles, practical prompting techniques, and safe workplace practices across routine office workflows. It is designed for business professionals, administrative staff, and project coordinators who possess basic office application skills but have no prior programming or AI background. After completing the training, learners will be able to draft correspondence, process spreadsheet data, direct supervised AI agents, and maintain organizational confidentiality and compliance standards.

DELIVERY FORMAT OPTIONS

Standard Instructor-Led Training (ILT). The instructor teaches each module, leads explanations and discussions, and guides students through the standard module labs using the published module timing.

Bootcamp / Lab-Centered Delivery. When Bootcamp Mode capstone labs are included, they provide an alternative delivery configuration, not additional required ILT lecture time. In this configuration, students primarily work through module labs and capstone lab scenarios while the trainer acts as a facilitator, answering questions, clarifying concepts, and helping students work through lab challenges.

Training providers may choose either the normal ILT model or the Bootcamp/lab-centered model based on audience readiness, delivery goals, and available class time.

AT COURSE COMPLETION

After completing this course, you will be able to:

Identify core generative AI concepts, capabilities, limitations, and workplace compliance rules concerning data privacy and intellectual property.

Construct structured, role-based prompts using proven prompting frameworks across major conversational AI platforms.

Generate, summarize, and refine professional business documents and communications while applying effective human-in-the-loop review.

Apply AI-assisted prompts to spreadsheet tasks including formula creation, data cleaning, and tabular summary generation.

Direct browser-based autonomous AI agents through multi-step administrative workflows while mitigating hallucinations and quality risks.

PREREQUISITES

- Basic familiarity with standard web browsers and office applications such as word processors and spreadsheets
 - No prior AI or technical experience required
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COURSE OUTLINE

MODULE 0 Course Orientation: Welcome & Overview (Optional)

30 min

Comprehensive orientation to AI Fundamentals for Knowledge Workers. Covers the complete curriculum roadmap, target audience background, prerequisite verification, hands-on environment and tooling readiness checklist, and recommended learning strategies. Facilitator Note: Instructors may utilize this 30-minute orientation window to administer the diagnostic Pre-Assessment test provided in the Trainer Preparation Guide to benchmark baseline learner proficiency before starting Module 1.

LESSONS

Lesson 1: Course Overview & Curriculum Roadmap — 10 min

Lesson 2: Target Audience & Prerequisites — 5 min

Lesson 3: Environment & Tooling Readiness Checklist — 10 min

Lesson 4: Learning Strategies & Course Navigation — 5 min

TIMING

Module total: 30 min

MODULE 1 AI Foundations, Responsible Use, and Workplace Governance

90 min

Understand core generative AI concepts, terminology, and organizational policies for data privacy and intellectual property protection.

LESSONS

LAB EXERCISES

Lesson 1: Understanding Generative AI Mechanics and Workplace Capabilities	— 15 min	Evaluating Prompts and Responses for Privacy and Compliance	— 30 min
Lesson 2: Governance, Data Privacy, and Risk Mitigation in the Office	— 15 min		
Lesson 3: Identifying Hallucinations, Model Bias, And Factual Errors	— 20 min		

TIMING

Review / Summary: 10 min · 4 questions **Module total:** 90 min

AFTER COMPLETING THIS MODULE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Identify core generative AI concepts, capabilities, and limitations in a workplace context
- Apply organizational compliance rules concerning data privacy and intellectual property when using AI tools
- Recognize model hallucinations, biases, and security risks in everyday outputs

MODULE 2 Prompt Engineering and Business Content Generation 85 min

Master structured prompting frameworks to generate clear, targeted business content across multiple conversational platforms.

LESSONS

Lesson 1: Anatomy of an Effective Prompt and Frameworks — 15 min

Lesson 2: Platform Comparison and Iterative Refinement Strategies — 15 min

Lesson 3: Iterative Refinement And Tone Adjustment Techniques — 15 min

LAB EXERCISES

Building and Testing Multi-Platform Business Prompts — 30 min

TIMING

Review / Summary: 10 min · 4 questions **Module total:** 85 min

AFTER COMPLETING THIS MODULE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Construct structured, role-based prompts using proven prompting frameworks
- Compare output variations across major conversational AI platforms using free browser tiers
- Iterate on prompt parameters to refine tone, format, and audience alignment

MODULE 3 Streamlining Document Drafting and Spreadsheet Analysis

90 min

Accelerate office productivity by drafting business correspondence, synthesizing reports, and executing spreadsheet tasks with AI assistance.

LESSONS

Lesson 1: Drafting and Refining Professional Correspondence — 15 min

Lesson 2: AI-Assisted Spreadsheet Operations and Data Cleaning — 15 min

Lesson 3: Spreadsheet Formula Generation, Data Cleaning, And Tabular Summaries — 20 min

LAB EXERCISES

Drafting Documents and Processing Spreadsheet Data — 30 min

TIMING

Review / Summary: 10 min · 4 questions **Module total:** 90 min

AFTER COMPLETING THIS MODULE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Generate, summarize, and refine professional business documents using AI assistance
- Apply human-in-the-loop review processes to verify factual accuracy and brand alignment
- Construct spreadsheet formulas, clean raw data, and generate tabular summaries using AI prompts

MODULE 4 Supervising Task-Oriented AI Agents and Everyday Workflows

95 min

Manage multi-step browser-based AI workflows and autonomous agent interactions while maintaining active human oversight.

LESSONS

Lesson 1: Understanding Browser-Based AI Agents and Multi-Step Workflows — 15 min

Lesson 2: Supervision Strategies and Maintaining Human Oversight — 15 min

Lesson 3: Integrate AI Task Automation Safely Into Daily Office Operational Habits — 25 min

LAB EXERCISES

Directing a Multi-Step Administrative Workflow with AI — 30 min

TIMING

Review / Summary: 10 min · 4 questions **Module total:** 95 min

AFTER COMPLETING THIS MODULE, YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Direct browser-based autonomous AI agents through multi-step administrative workflows
- Monitor agent execution steps to detect deviations, errors, and hallucinations
- Integrate AI task automation safely into daily office operational habits

BOOTCAMP MODE — CAPSTONE LABS

Capstone labs are included for Bootcamp/lab-centered delivery. They are not additional required lecture time for Standard Instructor-Led Training. Use them when the client chooses a facilitated lab delivery model where the trainer coaches students through integrated practice scenarios.

One integrative Capstone Lab is generated per course day. Each capstone presents a new scenario requiring students to independently apply the combined skills from that day's modules — no procedure, no hints. Students determine their own approach. Capstone Labs are the afternoon activity in Bootcamp delivery and replace the lecture portion of standard Instructor-Led Training.

DAY 1 CAPSTONE Modules 1, 2, 3, 4

SKILLS TO BE INTEGRATED

Evaluate workplace prompts and outputs against corporate privacy and compliance policies

Construct structured, role-based prompts using context, constraints, and format directives

Generate and refine professional business correspondence and spreadsheet summaries using human-in-the-loop review

Direct multi-step browser-based AI workflows while identifying and mitigating hallucinations and formatting errors

Capstone content is embedded in the student manuals and instructor guides — one section per day, after the final module for that day. A standalone Capstone Slides (.pptx) file is also included in the Courseware Publisher download package.